PATENT COOPERATION TREATY

From the
INTERNATIONAL SEARCHING AUTHORITY

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PCT

WRITTEN OPINION OF THE
INTERNATIONAL SEARCHING AUTHORITY

(PCT Rule 43*bis*.1)

Date of mailing *(day/month/year)*	07-07-2025
Applicant's or agent's file reference 1403122601	**FOR FURTHER ACTION** See paragraph 2 below

International application No.	International filing date *(day/month/year)*	Priority date *(day/month/year)*
PCT/IB2025/052753	16-03-2025	16-03-2025

International Patent Classification (IPC) or both national classification and IPC
G06Q10/1053,G06Q10/04,G06N20/00,G06F40/00 Version=2025.01

Applicant
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1. This opinion contains indications relating to the following items:

- [x] Box No. I Basis of the opinion
- [ ] Box No. II Priority
- [ ] Box No. III Non-establishment of opinion with regard to novelty, inventive step and industrial applicability
- [ ] Box No. IV Lack of unity of invention
- [x] Box No. V Reasoned statement under Rule 43*bis*.1(a)(i) with regard to novelty, inventive step and industrial applicability; citations and explanations supporting such statement
- [ ] Box No. VI Certain documents cited
- [ ] Box No. VII Certain defects in the international application
- [x] Box No. VIII Certain observations on the international application

2. **FURTHER ACTION**

If a demand for international preliminary examination is made, this opinion will be considered to be a written opinion of the International Preliminary Examining Authority ("IPEA") except that this does not apply where the applicant chooses an Authority other than this one to be the IPEA and the chosen IPEA has notified the International Bureau under Rule 66.1*bis*(b) that written opinions of this International Searching Authority will not be so considered.

If this opinion is, as provided above, considered to be a written opinion of the IPEA, the applicant is invited to submit to the IPEA a written reply together, where appropriate, with amendments, before the expiration of 3 months from the date of mailing of Form PCT/ISA/220 or before the expiration of 22 months from the priority date, whichever expires later.

For further options, see Form PCT/ISA/220.

Name and mailing address of the ISA/	Date of completion of this opinion	Authorized officer
Indian Patent Office Plot No. 32, Sector 14, Dwarka,New Delhi-110075 Facsimile No.	07-07-2025	Arun Prasad Telephone No. +91-1125300200

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Box No. I Basis of this opinion

1. With regard to the **language**, this opinion has been established on the basis of:

   ☒ the international application in the language in which it was filed.

   ☐ a translation of the international application into _____ which is the language of a translation furnished for the purposes of international search (Rules 12.3(a) and 23.1(b)).

2. ☐ This opinion has been established taking into account the **rectification of an obvious mistake** authorized by or notified to this Authority under Rule 91 (Rule 43*bis*.1(b)).

3. ☐ With regard to any **nucleotide and/or amino acid sequence** disclosed in the international application, this opinion has been established on the basis of a sequence listing:

   a. ☐ forming part of the international application as filed.

   b. ☐ furnished subsequent to the international filing date for the purposes of international search (Rule 13*ter*.1(a)),

      ☐ accompanied by a statement to the effect that the sequence listing does not go beyond the disclosure in the international application as filed.

4. ☐ With regard to any nucleotide and/or amino acid sequence disclosed in the international application, this opinion has been established to the extent that a meaningful opinion could be formed without a WIPO Standard ST.26 compliant sequence listing.

5. Additional comments:

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Box No. V **Reasoned statement under Rule 43*bis*.1(a)(i) with regard to novelty, inventive step and industrial applicability; citations and explanations supporting such statement**

1. Statement

Novelty (N)	Claims	NONE	YES
	Claims	1-6	NO
Inventive step (IS)	Claims	NONE	YES
	Claims	1-6	NO
Industrial applicability (IA)	Claims	1-6	YES
	Claims	NONE	NO

2. Citations and explanations:

Reference is made of the following document:

D1: WO2018026961A1 (PAYSA, INC.) 08 FEBRUARY 2018 (08-02-2018)

Novelty:

The present application does not meet the criteria of Article 33(2) PCT, because the subject-matter of claims 1-6 is not new in view of the disclosures of D1.

The current application relates to career counseling using AI and machine learning. It introduces a data-driven system offering personalized career guidance, skill evaluation, job-matching features, and career path prediction.

Regarding claims 1-3, D1 discloses AI-driven career recommendation system that uses machine learning and natural language processing to deliver highly personalized job and salary suggestions. At its core, the system ingests structured and unstructured data from both a candidate's profile (such as resumes, compensation history, skills, education, and job titles) and career path data (such as company-level compensation trends, geographic factors, and labor market dynamics).
Natural language processing modules in D1, extract relevant information from resumes, job descriptions, and unstructured documents using keyword extraction, document merging via spectral latent methods, and canonical fuzzy joins. This extracted data feeds into AI models that identify gaps, trends, and opportunities in career trajectories.

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Box No. VIII Certain observations on the international application

The following observations on the clarity of the claims, description, and drawings or on the question whether the claims are fully supported by the description, are made:

The claims 1-6 of the current application lack clarity in following ways:

1. Key terms like "analyze strengths," "recommend the appropriate career occasion," and "predict career options" are not clearly defined or linked to specific algorithms, data structures, or processing methods.

2. The role and implementation of AI, machine learning, and NLP are described at a high level without explaining the models used, training processes, or data requirements.

3. The system's ability to update suggestions "following market trends and user interaction" lacks explanation of data sources, update mechanisms, or real-time processing techniques. Similarly, the predictive analytics claim fails to specify statistical models or metrics used.

4. The feedback loop for course recommendations is not technically detailed, leaving ambiguity on how user input influences system updates.

5. Lastly, the UI mock interview and sentiment analysis modules are described without clarifying their architecture, NLP techniques, or scoring criteria.

The applicant should elaborate on the enablement in the claims to clearly highlight the technical advancement as required by PCT Article 6.

Supplemental Box

In case the space in any of the preceding boxes is not sufficient.
Continuation of:

Continuation of Citation and Explanation(Box5)

In the disclosure of D1, skill recommendation engines further enhance personalization by identifying complementary skills most likely to increase job placement success or salary growth, factoring in both static and dynamic market signals. These learning algorithms ensure that recommendations evolve over time in response to labor market changes and individual user progression.

([ABSTRACT, "…a processing system receives data associated with a career path and receives data associated with a candidate's career history. The processing system determines at least one of a suggested career position or a suggested salary…"], [CLAIMS 1-13, "…a suggested career position or a suggested salary associated with the candidate based on the data associated with the career path and the data associated with the candidate's career history… performing progressive and regressive temporal data analysis on data associated with at least one of complementary skill set acquisition, advance within or departure from a company by a candidate, progression of talent flow within at least one company… skill recommendation engine, wherein the data processing includes data associated with at least one of a career profile associated with the candidate…"], [PARAGRAPHS 23-27, 43-47, 115-117, 141-143 "…FIG. 15 is a block diagram depicting an embodiment of an artificial intelligence- based skill recommendation engine configured to provide a personalized skill recommendation to a candidate… salary recommendations may be personalized to the candidate based on the data associated with the career path and the data associated with the candidate's career history. Details of the personalization process are provided herein… statistical signal processing engine 1012 may include a natural language processing manager 1018 that is configured to implement natural language processing algorithms to process career data. For example, natural language processing methods may be used to extract information and key words from a candidate's resume or from a job description… FIG. 14 is a block diagram depicting an embodiment of an artificial intelligence- based job recommendation engine 1400 configured to match a candidate with at least one job. In some embodiments, certain functions associated with artificial intelligence (Al)-based matching of jobs to users (candidates) and users to jobs may be performed by AI job-user matching engine 1008 (FIG. 10) using latent and atomic static and dynamic structures associated with AI job-user matching engine 1008…"]).

Document D1 discloses all the features of claims 1-3; therefore, the subject-matter of claims 1-3 lacks novelty.

Dependent claims 4-6 do not appear to contain any additional features which, in combination with the features of any claim to which they refer, meet the requirements of the PCT with respect to

novelty in the sense of Article 33(2) PCT. These features are either explicitly disclosed in D1 or directly derivable from it.

Inventive Step:

The subject matter of claims 1-6 lacks an inventive step and thus doesn't meet the requirements of PCT Article 33(3) in view of the disclosure of D1, as stated above for novelty consideration.

Industrial Applicability:

The claimed subject matter of claims 1-6 is considered to be industrially applicable and thus fulfills the requirements of PCT Article 33(4).